

Word family: **crack / cracks / cracked / cracking / cracker**

Base word: crack

Part of speech: **noun**, **verb**, and sometimes **adjective**

Related forms:

* **crack** (n.) — 裂縫；裂痕；爆裂聲；嘗試；笑話

* **crack** (v.) — 裂開；打破；破解；發出爆裂聲；崩潰

* **cracked** (adj./participle) — 裂了的；有裂痕的

* **cracking** (adj., informal) — 很好的；極佳的

* **cracker** (n.) — 脆餅；爆竹；破解者 / 破解程式 *(context-dependent)*

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **a crack in the wall**

* **crack a window**

* **crack an egg**

* **crack under pressure**

* **crack a code**

* **crack a case**

* **crack a joke**

* **have a crack at**

* **the crack of dawn**

* **slip / fall through the cracks**

* **paper over the cracks**

* **crack down on**

* **crack up**

* **cracking good**

Meaning in this passage

> Page by page, it captured small moments that might otherwise have slipped through the **cracks**.

Here, **cracks** is part of the idiom:

slip through the cracks = 被遺漏；被忽視；沒有被注意到

The image is of something small falling through narrow gaps.

中文翻譯：

一頁一頁翻下去，裏面記錄的都是一些如果不特別留住，就很容易**被遺漏、被忘記**的小片段。

So here:

cracks = metaphorical gaps in attention, memory, or a system

1. **crack (裂縫 ; 裂痕) — 裂縫 ; 裂痕**

This is the core physical noun sense.

Practice 1

> There is a **crack** in the wall.

牆上有一道**裂縫**。

Practice 2

> Water was leaking through a **crack** in the pipe.

水從水管的一道**裂縫**漏出來。

Practice 3

> A small **crack** appeared in the glass.

玻璃上出現了一條小**裂痕**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crack = a narrow break or split in a hard surface or material****

中文 :

****硬物表面上的狹窄裂口或裂痕****

2. **crack (縫隙 ; 細小開口) — 縫隙 ; 窄縫**

Practice 1

> Light came through a **crack** in the door.

光線從門的一條**縫隙**照進來。

Practice 2

> He looked through the **crack** between the curtains.

他從窗簾之間的**細縫**望出去。

MCQ-ready definition:

crack = a very narrow opening between two surfaces or objects

中文：

兩個表面或物件之間很窄的開口

3. **slip through the cracks — 被遺漏；被忽略**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Some small moments might otherwise have **slipped through the cracks**.

有些小片段**否則可能就被遺忘了**。

Practice 2

> Some students **slip through the cracks** in large schools.

在大型學校裏，有些學生可能會**被忽略**。

Practice 3

> Important details can easily **slip through the cracks**.

重要細節很容易**被遺漏**。

MCQ-ready definition:

slip through the cracks = fail to be noticed, remembered, protected, or dealt with

中文：

因制度、注意力或記憶上的空隙而被遺漏、忽視或忘記

4. ****fall through the cracks — 被漏掉；沒有得到處理****

Very close to ****slip through the cracks****.

Practice 1

> Some applications ****fell through the cracks****.

有些申請****被漏掉了****。

Practice 2

> We need a better system so that no case ****falls through the cracks****.

我們需要更好的制度，避免任何個案****被遺漏****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fall through the cracks = be missed because of gaps in a system or process****

5. ****paper over the cracks — 掩飾問題；治標不治本****

A useful idiom.

Practice 1

> The temporary solution only ****papered over the cracks****.

這個臨時方案只是****掩飾問題****。

Practice 2

> They tried to ****paper over the cracks**** instead of fixing the real issue.

他們只是試圖****掩蓋問題表面****，而沒有真正解決核心問題。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****paper over the cracks = hide signs of a problem without solving the underlying cause****

中文：

****只把問題表面遮掩起來，而沒有解決根本原因****

6. **crack (verb : 裂開 ; 出現裂痕) — 裂開 ; 龜裂**

Practice 1

> The glass **cracked** when it hit the floor.

玻璃掉到地上時**裂了**。

Practice 2

> The dry ground began to **crack**.

乾燥的土地開始**龜裂**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crack = develop a narrow split without necessarily breaking completely apart****

中文 :

****出現裂縫，但不一定完全斷開****

7. **crack something — 使某物裂開**

Practice 1

> The impact **cracked the screen**.

撞擊令螢幕**裂了**。

Practice 2

> Be careful not to **crack the plate**.

小心不要把碟子**弄裂**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crack something = cause a hard object or surface to develop a split****

8. **crack an egg — 打蛋 ; 敲開蛋殼**

Practice 1

> **Crack two eggs** into a bowl.

把兩隻蛋**敲開**打進碗裏。

Practice 2

> She **cracked the egg** on the edge of the pan.

她在平底鍋邊把蛋**敲開**。

MCQ-ready definition:

crack an egg = break the shell open, usually for cooking

中文：

把蛋殼敲破並打開

9. **crack a nut — 敲開堅果殼**

Practice 1

> He used a tool to **crack the nuts**.

他的工具**敲開堅果殼**。

Practice 2

> These shells are difficult to **crack**.

這些果殼很難**敲開**。

MCQ-ready definition:

crack a nut = break open a hard shell

10. **crack a window / door — 把窗 / 門打開一條縫**

A very useful everyday sense.

Practice 1

> Could you **crack the window**?

可以把窗**開一條縫**嗎？

Practice 2

> She **cracked the door open** and looked outside.

她把門**打開一條小縫**，往外看。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crack a window/door = open it slightly****

中文：

****只打開一點點，留下一條窄縫****

11. ****crack (爆裂聲；咄的一聲) — 爆裂聲；清脆聲****

Practice 1

> We heard a loud **crack**.

我們聽到一聲很響的****爆裂聲****。

Practice 2

> There was a sharp **crack** of thunder.

傳來一聲尖銳的****雷鳴爆響****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crack = a sudden sharp sound like something breaking or exploding****

中文：

****像東西斷裂、爆開時發出的突然清脆聲響****

12. ****crack (verb : 發出爆裂 / 清脆聲) — 咄地響；爆響****

Practice 1

> The branches **cracked** in the wind.

樹枝在風中發出**啪裂聲**。

Practice 2

> Thunder **cracked** overhead.

頭頂傳來**轟然雷響**。

MCQ-ready definition:

crack = make a sudden sharp breaking-like sound

13. **crack your knuckles — 扳手指關節發出聲響**

Practice 1

> He always **cracks his knuckles** when he's nervous.

他緊張時總喜歡**扳手指關節發出啪啪聲**。

Practice 2

> She **cracked her knuckles** before starting work.

她開始工作前**扳響了手指關節**。

MCQ-ready definition:

crack your knuckles = pull or bend finger joints so they make a popping sound

14. **crack a whip — 甩鞭發出響聲**

Practice 1

> The rider **cracked the whip**.

騎手**甩鞭發出啪的一聲**。

Practice 2

> The trainer **cracked his whip** in the air.

訓練員在空中**甩響鞭子**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crack a whip = move a whip sharply so it makes a loud snapping sound****

15. ****crack (聲音突然變尖 / 破音) — 破音 ; 嗓音突然改變****

Practice 1

> His voice ****cracked**** during the speech.

他演講時聲音****突然破音****。

Practice 2

> Her voice ****cracked with emotion****.

她因情緒激動而****聲音顫裂****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****voice cracks = the voice suddenly changes pitch or becomes unstable****

中文 :

****聲音突然失去穩定，變尖、變啞或破音****

16. ****crack a code — 破解密碼 / 代碼****

A major figurative/technical sense.

Practice 1

> They finally ****cracked the code****.

他們終於****破解了密碼****。

Practice 2

> The team is trying to ****crack the encryption****.

團隊正試圖****破解加密系統****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crack a code = successfully discover how a code or encryption system works****

中文：

****成功破解密碼、代碼或加密方法****

17. ****crack a case — 破案；破解案件****

Practice 1

> The detective finally ****cracked the case****.

偵探終於****破了案****。

Practice 2

> New evidence helped police ****crack the case****.

新證據幫助警方****偵破案件****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crack a case = solve a difficult crime or mystery****

中文：

****成功解開案件真相****

18. ****crack a problem — 解開難題****

Practice 1

> Scientists are trying to ****crack the problem****.

科學家正努力****解開這個難題****。

Practice 2

> We finally ****cracked the puzzle****.

我們終於****破解了謎題****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crack a problem/puzzle = successfully solve something difficult****

19. **crack under pressure — 在壓力下崩潰 / 撐不住**

A major figurative sense.

Practice 1

> He stayed calm and didn't **crack under pressure**.

他保持冷靜，沒有在壓力下**撐不住**。

Practice 2

> Some people **crack under intense pressure**.

有些人在巨大壓力下會**崩潰**。

MCQ-ready definition:

crack under pressure = lose emotional control or ability to cope because of stress

中文：

因壓力太大而心理上或表現上崩潰

20. **crack (使人崩潰；突破心理防線) — 擊垮；使招供**

Practice 1

> The long questioning finally **cracked him**.

長時間盤問最終**擊垮了他的心理防線**。

Practice 2

> Investigators hoped the pressure would **crack the suspect**.

調查人員希望壓力會令疑犯**崩潰並透露真相**。

MCQ-ready definition:

crack someone = make someone lose resistance or emotional control

21. **crack a joke — 開玩笑；說笑話**

Practice 1

> He **cracked a joke** to relax everyone.

他**說了個笑話**讓大家放鬆。

Practice 2

> She is always **cracking jokes** in class.

她上課時總是**說笑話**。

MCQ-ready definition:

crack a joke = make or tell a joke, often suddenly or casually

中文：

隨口說一個笑話

22. **crack a smile — 終於露出笑容**

Practice 1

> He finally **cracked a smile**.

他終於**露出了一絲笑容**。

Practice 2

> She didn't **crack a smile** during the entire meeting.

整個會議期間她連**笑一下**都沒有。

MCQ-ready definition:

crack a smile = begin to smile, especially after being serious

中文：

原本嚴肅時終於露出一點笑容

23. **have a crack at something — 試一試**

Especially BrE/AusE informal.

Practice 1

> I'll **have a crack at it**.

我來**試一試**。

Practice 2

> Why don't you **have a crack at the question**?

你何不**試着回答這條問題**？

MCQ-ready definition:

have a crack at something = informal: try to do something, especially something difficult

中文：

嘗試做某件事，尤其是有點難度的事

24. **take a crack at something — 試着做某事**

Especially AmE.

Practice 1

> Let me **take a crack at it**.

讓我來**試試看**。

Practice 2

> She **took a crack at solving the puzzle**.

她**試着解那個謎題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

take a crack at X = informal: make an attempt at X

25. **a crack at something — 一次嘗試**

Practice 1

> Give me **a crack at the problem**.

讓我**試着解這個問題**。

Practice 2

> Everyone deserves **a crack at the job**.

每個人都應該有**嘗試爭取這份工作的機會**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a crack at X = an attempt or opportunity to try X

26. **the crack of dawn — 黎明時分；天剛亮**

A fixed expression.

Practice 1

> We left at **the crack of dawn**.

我們在**天剛亮時**出發。

Practice 2

> He gets up at **the crack of dawn** every day.

他每天**黎明時分**就起床。

MCQ-ready definition:

the crack of dawn = the very beginning of daylight, very early in the morning

中文：

天剛開始亮的時候

27. **crack down on something — 嚴厲打擊；加強管制**

A major phrasal verb.

Practice 1

> The school is **cracking down on cheating**.

學校正**嚴厲打擊作弊行為**。

Practice 2

> Authorities **cracked down on illegal parking**.

當局**加強取締違例泊車**。

MCQ-ready definition:

crack down on X = take stronger action to stop or punish X

中文：

採取更嚴厲措施制止或懲罰某行為

28. **a crackdown — 嚴厲打擊；整治行動**

Practice 1

> The city launched a **crackdown on illegal parking**.

市政府展開**打擊違例泊車的整治行動**。

Practice 2

> A new **crackdown** began this week.

新一輪**嚴厲執法行動**本週展開。

MCQ-ready definition:

crackdown = a period of strong enforcement against unwanted or illegal behaviour

29. **crack up — 笑翻；大笑**

Informal.

Practice 1

> That joke **cracked me up**.

那個笑話令我**笑翻了**。

Practice 2

> Everyone **cracked up** when he told the story.

他說完那個故事後，大家都**大笑起來**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crack up / crack someone up = informal: laugh a lot / make someone laugh a lot****

30. **crack up — 精神崩潰**

Another sense of the same phrasal verb.

Practice 1

> The stress nearly made him **crack up**.

壓力差點令他**精神崩潰**。

Practice 2

> She felt as though she was **cracking up**.

她覺得自己快要**撐不住 / 精神崩潰**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crack up = informal: lose emotional or mental stability****

Context is essential because this can also mean ****laugh uncontrollably****.

31. **cracker (脆餅；薄脆餅乾) — 脆餅；餅乾**

Practice 1

> She ate cheese and **crackers**.

她吃芝士配**脆餅**。

Practice 2

> These **crackers** are very salty.

這些**脆餅乾**很鹹。

MCQ-ready definition:

cracker = a thin, crisp, usually savoury biscuit

32. **cracker (爆竹) — 爆竹**

Often in compounds such as **firecracker**.

Practice 1

> The children heard a **cracker** go off outside.

孩子們聽到外面有**爆竹**響。

Practice 2

> Fire**crackers** filled the street with noise.

爆竹聲響遍街道。

MCQ-ready definition:

cracker = a small explosive device that makes a loud bang

33. **cracker (破解者 / 破解程式) — 破解者**

A computing/security sense.

Practice 1

> The system was targeted by a password **cracker**.

系統遭到密碼**破解工具 / 破解者**攻擊。

Practice 2

> A **cracker** attempts to break security protections.

破解者試圖突破安全保護。

MCQ-ready definition:

cracker = someone or something that breaks digital protection or codes

34. **cracking** (很好的 ; 一流的) — 很棒的 ; 一流的

BrE informal.

Practice 1

> That was a **cracking** performance.

那是一場**非常精彩的**演出。

Practice 2

> We had a **cracking** time.

我們玩得**非常開心**。

MCQ-ready definition:

cracking = BrE informal: excellent, exciting, or very enjoyable

35. **crack** (adjective : 頂尖的 ; 精銳的) — 一流的 ; 精銳的

An established adjective sense.

Practice 1

> They sent in a **crack team** of investigators.

他們派出一支**精銳調查團隊**。

Practice 2

> She is a **crack shot**.

她是一名**神槍手 / 射擊高手**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****crack + noun = exceptionally skilled or high-quality****

中文：

****技術一流、非常出色的****

Important distinction 1: **crack vs break**

**crack**

usually means a split appears but the object may remain in one piece.

**break**

broader and may mean complete separation or loss of function.

> The screen cracked.

螢幕裂了。

> The screen broke.

螢幕壞了 / 破了。

A cracked object is not necessarily completely broken.

Important distinction 2: **crack vs split**

**crack**

often narrow and relatively small.

**split**

often suggests a larger separation into parts.

> a crack in the wall

牆上一條裂縫

> the wood split in two

木頭裂成兩半

Important distinction 3: **crack vs gap**

crack

a narrow opening usually caused by breaking/splitting.

gap

any empty space between things.

Every crack is a kind of gap, but not every gap is a crack.

Important distinction 4: **slip through the cracks literal vs figurative**

Literal image

something physically passes through a narrow gap.

Figurative idiom

someone/something gets missed.

In your passage, there are no literal cracks.

The **cracks** are metaphorical gaps in memory and attention.

Important distinction 5: **crack a window does not mean damage it**

Very important.

> crack the window

can mean:

open it slightly

not:

break the glass

Context decides.

Important distinction 6: **crack an egg vs break an egg**

Both are possible, but:

crack an egg

specifically break the shell open for use.

break an egg

broader and can sound accidental.

Important distinction 7: **crack a code vs break a code**

Both can mean successfully decipher it.

Crack often emphasizes solving something difficult through skill or analysis.

Important distinction 8: **crack a joke vs tell a joke**

tell a joke

neutral.

crack a joke

more informal and often suggests a quick spontaneous joke.

Important distinction 9: **crack under pressure vs break down**

crack under pressure

lose control because of pressure.

break down

broader:

- * machine stops working
- * person becomes emotionally overwhelmed
- * system fails

****Crack**** strongly highlights pressure causing failure.

Important distinction 10: ****crack up** has opposite-feeling senses

****crack up laughing****

大笑不止

****crack up mentally****

精神崩潰

Context is essential.

Important distinction 11: ****have a crack at** vs **crack something**

****have a crack at****

try.

****crack something****

solve successfully.

> I'll have a crack at the puzzle.

我試試解謎題。

> I cracked the puzzle.

我成功解開了。

This is a lovely contrast:

attempt vs success

Important distinction 12: **crack down vs crack up**

Completely different phrasal verbs:

crack down on

嚴厲打擊

crack up

大笑 / 精神崩潰

Do not infer meaning from **crack** alone.

Important distinction 13: **crack noun vs crack adjective**

Noun

> a crack in the glass

玻璃裂縫

Adjective

> a crack team

精銳團隊

The adjective sense means **excellent / highly skilled**, not cracked or broken.

Family-extension note

Crack has several major modern branches:

1. **physical split/opening**

- * crack in the wall
- * crack in glass
- * narrow crack

2. **make/open a split**

- * glass cracks
- * crack an egg
- * crack a window

3. **sharp sound**

- * loud crack
- * crack of thunder
- * crack your knuckles

4. **solve/break through**

- * crack a code
- * crack a case
- * crack a puzzle

5. **psychological failure under pressure**

- * crack under pressure
- * crack someone

6. **speech/humour**

- * crack a joke
- * crack a smile

7. **attempt**

- * have/take a crack at

8. **fixed idioms**

- * slip through the cracks
- * paper over the cracks
- * crack of dawn
- * crack down on
- * crack up

9. **quality**

- * crack team
- * cracking performance

The underlying metaphor often involves:

a hard surface or barrier giving way

That can become:

- * a literal surface,
- * a code,
- * a case,
- * emotional resistance,
- * or a system with “gaps.”

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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crack (noun)	裂縫；裂痕	narrow split
crack (gap)	細縫	narrow opening
slip through the cracks	被遺漏 / 忽視	missed through gaps
fall through the cracks	被漏掉	missed by system
paper over the cracks	掩飾問題	hide underlying flaws
crack (verb)	裂開	develop split
crack something	使裂開	cause split
crack an egg	打蛋	break shell
crack a window	把窗開一條縫	open slightly
crack (sound)	爆裂聲	sharp sound
crack your knuckles	扳響關節	popping sound
voice cracks	破音	unstable voice
crack a code	破解密碼	solve code
crack a case	破案	solve case
crack a puzzle	破解難題	solve difficult problem
crack under pressure	在壓力下崩潰	fail under stress
crack a joke	說笑話	make joke
crack a smile	露出笑容	start smiling
have/take a crack at	試一試	attempt
crack of dawn	黎明	first light
crack down on	嚴厲打擊	stronger enforcement
crackdown	整治 / 打擊行動	enforcement
crack up	大笑 / 精神崩潰	two idiomatic senses
cracker	脆餅；爆竹；破解者	lexicalized branches
cracking	很棒的	BrE informal

| **crack team** | 精銳團隊 | exceptionally skilled |

For your original sentence

> Page by page, it captured small moments that might otherwise have slipped through the
cracks.

Here:

cracks = 記憶、注意力或生活中的「縫隙」

and the whole expression:

slip through the cracks = 不知不覺被忽略、遺漏或遺忘

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 一頁一頁翻下去，裏面記錄的都是一些如果不特別留住，就很容易**被遺漏、被遺忘**的小片段。

The metaphor works particularly well here: tiny memories are imagined as little things that could
fall through gaps and disappear unless someone deliberately preserves them.